Counterpart Cards · as of 2026-07-27

CHIPS Program Office (CPO), National Institute of Standards and Technology, U.S. Department of Commerce

Bill Frauenhofer — Director, CHIPS Program Office

WHERE IT SITS

Housed within NIST at the Department of Commerce and, since a March 31, 2025 executive order, administered under the U.S. Investment Accelerator at Commerce; the Director is a non-Senate-confirmed appointee answering to the Secretary of Commerce (Howard Lutnick), and the office is funded by CHIPS Act of 2022 appropriations (P.L. 117-167) that are available until expended rather than by annual appropriations.

WORKING LEVEL

Lynelle McKay, Chief Portfolio Management Officer, CHIPS Program Office (appointed July 2024; continuation into 2026 not re-verified). Note: Michael Grimes ran the umbrella U.S. Investment Accelerator until his departure in January 2026, after which Secretary Howard Lutnick assumed direct control of the Accelerator.

FIREPOWER

- **Direct funding awards (grants/cooperative agreements)** — Incentive awards for construction, expansion, or modernization of U.S. semiconductor fabrication, packaging, and materials/equipment facilities under Sec. 9902 (15 U.S.C. 4652) *($39 billion appropriated for manufacturing incentives; roughly $33.7 billion in direct-funding awards signed with ~20 companies as of January 2025 (Commerce OIG status report), leaving limited unobligated grant headroom that the current administration is renegotiating)*
- **Direct loans and loan guarantees** — CHIPS Act authority to make or guarantee loans to covered semiconductor projects *(Up to $75 billion in direct loan/loan-guarantee principal authorized; only a small fraction committed (e.g., up to $5 billion in proposed loans in the TSMC package), so this authority remains largely untapped as of 2025-2026)*
- **Equity stakes (via U.S. Investment Accelerator)** — Conversion of CHIPS grant obligations into government equity ownership in award recipients *($8.9 billion converted into a ~9.9-10% common-stock stake in Intel (433.3 million shares at $20.47), closed August 2025, funded from $5.7B in undisbursed CHIPS grants plus $3.2B of Secure Enclave funds; the Accelerator also houses U.S. stakes in rare-earth companies and the government's US Steel board seat)*
- **CHIPS R&D programs (adjacent, run by CHIPS R&D Office)** — Funding for the National Semiconductor Technology Center, advanced packaging, and metrology programs adjacent to the incentives program *($11 billion of the $52.7 billion CHIPS Act total is for R&D (administered by the separate CHIPS R&D Office within NIST))*

TRACK RECORD

Under the prior administration the office moved from zero to roughly $33.7 billion in signed, binding awards with about 20 companies in under two years, including finalized packages for Intel ($7.86B), TSMC ($6.6B), Micron ($6.1B+), Samsung ($4.745B), GlobalFoundries, TI, and a tail of supplier awards (Hemlock, Corning, Edwards Vacuum, Infinera, HP) closed in January 2025. In 2025-2026 the Trump administration shifted the model: Secretary Lutnick testified (June 2025) that direct grants should be roughly 4% or less of project value, deals were renegotiated, and in August 2025 Intel's remaining grants were converted into an $8.9 billion, ~10% equity stake — the signature transaction of the new approach. As of mid-2026 no awards had been publicly rescinded; TSMC's Arizona fabs entered volume production and Phase 2 tool-in was scheduled for Q3 2026.

MANDATE

Implements the CHIPS incentives program under Section 9902 of the FY2021 NDAA (15 U.S.C. 4652), as funded by the CHIPS Act of 2022: provide federal financial assistance (grants, loans, loan guarantees) to incentivize construction, expansion, and modernization of semiconductor fabrication, assembly, testing, advanced packaging, and materials/equipment facilities located in the United States.

CAN'T / CONSTRAINTS

Statutory guardrails bar recipients from materially expanding semiconductor manufacturing capacity in foreign countries of concern (e.g., China, Russia) for 10 years and from using award funds for stock buybacks or dividends, with clawback provisions; funds may go only to 'covered entities' for U.S.-located semiconductor facilities, and awards over $150 million carry upside-sharing requirements. The office cannot fund overseas projects and has no authority beyond the semiconductor purposes in statute.

WANTS

2025-2026 priorities per Lutnick testimony and the Investment Accelerator EO: renegotiate 'overly generous' Biden-era awards to hold direct grants to roughly 4% or less of project value, take equity or other upside for taxpayers in exchange for CHIPS money, and use the Investment Accelerator to fast-track private investments exceeding $1 billion (paired with tariff pressure to induce fab reshoring).

⚠ No appropriations cliff (CHIPS funds are available until expended), but material restructuring risk: the office was folded under the U.S. Investment Accelerator by executive order on March 31, 2025; President Trump publicly urged Congress to scrap the CHIPS Act in his March 2025 joint address (no repeal advanced); and Accelerator leadership churned when Michael Grimes departed in January 2026, with Secretary Lutnick taking direct control.

USIA angle — Our in-house grant program, distinct from the sovereign pool. Pair CHIPS grants with the 48D tax credit in semis packages, and treat award renegotiations as where our equity-position precedents get set — every term becomes the template for how we structure sovereign-pool investments too. Watch: milestone compliance is our own report card, and we're simultaneously asking this office for staff.

NOT FULLY VERIFIED

Frauenhofer's appointment (July 2025) is well sourced, but no July-2026 source explicitly re-confirms he remains Director; no departure has been reported.; Lynelle McKay's continued service as Chief Portfolio Management Officer in 2026 is unverified (appointment sourced to July 2024).; Exact remaining unobligated grant capacity within the $39B after renegotiations and the Intel equity conversion could not be verified to a current figure.; The 'up to $5 billion in loans' figure for TSMC and the near-untapped status of the $75B loan authority are from stored knowledge/secondary trackers, not a 2026 official source.

Economic Development Administration (EDA), U.S. Department of Commerce

Ben Page — Deputy Assistant Secretary for Economic Development and Chief Operating Officer, performing the non-exclusive functions and duties of the Assistant Secretary of Commerce for Economic Development **(acting)**

WHERE IT SITS

A bureau of the Department of Commerce statutorily led by an Assistant Secretary for Economic Development — a Senate-confirmed position that is vacant as of mid-2026, with Deputy Assistant Secretary/COO Ben Page performing the duties and reporting to the Secretary of Commerce; funded through annual Commerce-Justice-Science discretionary appropriations plus periodic disaster supplementals.

FIREPOWER

- **Public Works and Economic Adjustment Assistance (EAA) grants** — Construction, infrastructure, planning, and technical-assistance grants to economically distressed communities *(Regular annual EDA appropriations have run in the roughly $400-500 million range in recent years; the FY2026 President's Budget proposed zero (elimination))*
- **Disaster Supplemental (EAA disaster funding)** — Economic-recovery and flood-mitigation grants for areas with 2023-2024 presidential major disaster declarations, deployed via three FY2025 funding 'pathways' *($1.51 billion provided by P.L. 118-158 (American Relief Act, December 2024); being awarded through 2025-2026)*
- **Regional Technology and Innovation Hubs (Tech Hubs)** — Consortium-based awards to build regional technology clusters, authorized by the CHIPS and Science Act *($10 billion authorized FY2023-FY2027 but only ~$541 million appropriated; ~$504M in Phase 2 implementation awards to 12 hubs (July 2024) plus ~$210M to 6 additional hubs (January 2025))*
- **Distressed Area Recompete Pilot Program** — Grants targeting areas with large prime-age employment gaps *(~$200 million appropriated (of $1B authorized); FY2026 budget proposed eliminating it)*
- **Build to Scale, University Centers, Partnership Planning, Revolving Loan Funds** — Smaller innovation/capacity grants and a legacy portfolio of locally administered revolving business-loan funds

TRACK RECORD

EDA historically makes hundreds of grants a year at modest ticket sizes, but scaled up sharply after 2021, deploying a $3 billion ARPA portfolio (including the $1B Build Back Better Regional Challenge and $500M Good Jobs Challenge) and roughly $700M+ in Tech Hubs awards across 2024-January 2025. In 2025-2026 its main activity has been standing up and awarding the $1.51B disaster supplemental via three funding pathways and completing a congressionally approved bureau-wide reorganization (announced April 2026) that consolidated operations into an Office of Regional Operations, an Office of Innovation and Entrepreneurship, and a new Office of Disaster Recovery and Resilience. Ben Page testified before House Transportation & Infrastructure in January 2026 on the agency's modernization.

MANDATE

Under the Public Works and Economic Development Act of 1965 (42 U.S.C. 3121 et seq.), as comprehensively reauthorized by the Economic Development Reauthorization Act of 2024 (P.L. 118-272), EDA must provide grants and technical assistance to economically distressed communities to generate employment and stimulate private investment, and serves as a lead federal agency for economic recovery coordination after disasters; EDRA established five statutory investment priorities and directed attention to small, rural, under-resourced, and tribal communities.

CAN'T / CONSTRAINTS

EDA generally cannot grant directly to for-profit businesses — eligible recipients are state and local governments, tribes, economic development districts, universities, and nonprofits — and most programs require applicants to meet statutory economic-distress criteria and provide non-federal cost share. Its authorization of appropriations runs through FY2029 under EDRA 2024.

WANTS

Agency leadership's stated 2025-2026 priorities (Page testimony, January 2026; April 2026 modernization update) are operational streamlining — fewer management layers, two program offices, faster grant processing — plus rapid deployment of the $1.51B disaster supplemental and implementation of EDRA 2024. The administration's own stated preference, however, is winding the bureau down: the FY2026 and FY2027 budget requests propose eliminating EDA on federalism grounds.

⚠ Sharp tension between statute and budget: EDRA 2024 (P.L. 118-272, enacted January 2025 as part of the WRDA package) reauthorized EDA through FY2029 — its first reauthorization in about two decades — while the President's FY2026 and FY2027 discretionary requests propose eliminating the agency entirely; bipartisan Senate pushback (e.g., Alsobrooks and Cramer) opposes closure, and a major reorganization was completed in April 2026. Outcome depends on annual appropriations.

USIA angle — Complement, not co-investor: workforce, infrastructure, and ecosystem money around a megasite — and the referral home for sub-$1B inbound that doesn't meet our bar, so nothing credible leaves empty-handed.

NOT FULLY VERIFIED

Ben Page's exact current title wording is drawn from search snippets of eda.gov and his January 2026 House testimony; the eda.gov leadership page itself could not be fetched directly (403).; The 'roughly $400-500 million' recent regular annual appropriation range is an approximation from stored knowledge; exact FY2025 enacted level not verified.; Tech Hubs award figures (~$504M to 12 hubs, ~$210M to 6 hubs) and Recompete ~$200M are from stored knowledge consistent with CRS titles found, but not re-verified against a 2026 document.; Whether any Assistant Secretary nominee for Economic Development is pending before the Senate as of July 2026 could not be determined.

International Trade Administration (ITA) / SelectUSA, U.S. Department of Commerce

William (Will) Kimmitt — Under Secretary of Commerce for International Trade

WHERE IT SITS

ITA is a bureau of the Department of Commerce headed by the Senate-confirmed Under Secretary for International Trade (Kimmitt, confirmed 51-47 on July 29, 2025, sworn in August 7, 2025), who reports to Secretary of Commerce Howard Lutnick; SelectUSA is the federal investment-promotion program housed in ITA's Global Markets unit, and the bureau is funded by annual discretionary appropriations supplemented by user fees for some trade services.

WORKING LEVEL

Ashok Pinto, Executive Director of SelectUSA (named spring 2025; has also performed the duties of Assistant Secretary for Global Markets and Director General of the U.S. and Foreign Commercial Service). Kelly Coldiron appears as SelectUSA Acting Executive Director in some 2026 Summit communications — which of the two currently holds the ED role as of July 2026 is not cleanly verifiable.

FIREPOWER

- **SelectUSA investor facilitation services** — Free, geographically neutral counseling, federal-regulatory ombudsman services, and matchmaking between foreign investors and U.S. state/local economic development organizations — no money changes hands *(Services-based, not a funding program; has facilitated $135+ billion in cumulative U.S. investment projects supporting 105,000+ jobs since 2011 (as of 2025))*
- **SelectUSA Investment Summit** — Annual flagship FDI-attraction event convening investors from 100+ markets with U.S. economic developers *(2026 Summit (May 3-6, National Harbor, MD) catalyzed over $56 billion in investment commitments and plans with 5,500+ attendees; 2027 Summit set for May 2-5, 2027)*
- **U.S. and Foreign Commercial Service / Advocacy Center / trade missions** — Export promotion, commercial diplomacy in ~80 international markets, and government-to-government advocacy for U.S. bidders on foreign procurements *(Funded within ITA's annual appropriation (roughly $600M-range bureau budget in recent years); no lending or grant capacity)*
- **Enforcement and Compliance (AD/CVD)** — Administers antidumping and countervailing duty law and monitors trade-agreement compliance — regulatory leverage rather than capital

TRACK RECORD

SelectUSA's cumulative facilitation stands at $135+ billion in investment projects and 105,000+ jobs since 2011. The May 2025 Summit was the largest in its history (5,500+ attendees, 100+ markets, 1,100+ economic developers); the May 2026 Summit matched that scale and reported over $56 billion in investment commitments and plans, including $1.1 billion announced by Indian companies. Under Kimmitt (sworn in August 2025), ITA has run the Summit machinery on schedule, announced the 2027 Summit, and continued AD/CVD enforcement supporting the administration's tariff-forward trade agenda.

MANDATE

ITA (established 1980 under Reorganization Plan No. 3 of 1979) must strengthen the competitiveness of U.S. industry, promote trade and inbound investment, and ensure fair trade through enforcement of antidumping/countervailing duty laws and trade-agreement compliance. SelectUSA, created by Executive Order 13577 (June 2011), must coordinate federal FDI-attraction activity and serve as a single federal point of contact and ombudsman for investors.

CAN'T / CONSTRAINTS

SelectUSA must remain geographically neutral among U.S. states and territories and provides no financial incentives — grants, tax breaks, and site inducements come only from state and local governments; ITA more broadly has no grant or loan authority for investors. AD/CVD determinations are bound by the statutory standards of Title VII of the Tariff Act of 1930 and cannot be issued at policy discretion.

WANTS

2025-2026 priorities per Commerce press materials and Kimmitt's public role: maximize inbound FDI as the complement to the administration's tariff/reshoring agenda ('invest in America to sell in America'), grow the Summit pipeline (record 2026 attendance, $56B in commitments, 2027 Summit announced), and aggressively enforce trade-remedy laws to defend U.S. industry.

⚠ No reauthorization cliff for ITA itself (annual appropriations); the structural soft spot is that SelectUSA rests on Executive Order 13577 and annual appropriations rather than a permanent statutory charter — periodic codification bills have not been enacted as far as could be verified.

USIA angle — Our origination funnel: inbound FDI leads and the state-incentive channel. Keep a named liaison so a SelectUSA lead reaches our screening within days, not quarters. Also Kroon's home agency — a warm bridge.

NOT FULLY VERIFIED

Current SelectUSA Executive Director as of July 2026 is ambiguous: Ashok Pinto was named ED in spring 2025, but Kelly Coldiron appears as 'Acting Executive Director' in some 2026 Summit promotional material; sequencing could not be resolved from available sources.; The ITA bureau budget characterization ('roughly $600M-range') is from stored knowledge, not a verified FY2025/FY2026 enacted figure.; Dollar results attributed to the 2025 Summit itself were inconsistently reported (one summary cited 'over $1 billion' announced at the event vs. the $56B commitments figure at the 2026 Summit); the 2025 event-specific investment total was not independently verified.; The claim that no SelectUSA codification bill has been enacted is based on absence of evidence in searches, not a definitive legislative-history check.; Verifier (capacity): corrected — The $135+ billion / 105,000+ jobs figure is the SelectUSA Investment Summit-specific statistic (investment generated via the annual Summit since 2011), not the program's overall investor-facilitation total. Program-wide, Commerce announced in January 2024 that SelectUSA had facilitated more than $200 billion in client-verified FDI supporting more than

200,000 U.S. jobs, and trade.gov's current About SelectUSA page cites more than $400 billion facilitated, creating and/or retaining over 270,000 U.S. jobs. The claim materially understates (and mislabels) SelectUSA's cumulative facilitation.

Office of Strategic Capital (OSC), U.S. Department of Defense (currently styled Department of War)

David A. Lorch — Director, Office of Strategic Capital, and Senior Advisor to the Deputy Secretary of War

WHERE IT SITS

An OSD office codified at 10 U.S.C. 149 by the FY2024 NDAA (P.L. 118-31); its director is appointed by the Secretary of Defense (not Senate-confirmed) and, following a 2025 reorganization, reports to the Under Secretary of Defense for Research and Engineering (Emil Michael), with funding coming from defense appropriations credit-subsidy accounts (FY2024 appropriations supporting $984M in loans; $500M mandatory credit subsidy from the July 2025 One Big Beautiful Bill Act).

FIREPOWER

- **Direct loans (covered-technology equipment financing)** — Direct loans for equipment/capital assets in 30+ statutorily defined covered technology categories under the 10 U.S.C. 149-note pilot program *(Initial $984M tranche (NOFA Sept 2024); superseded in scale by P.L. 119-21)*
- **Critical-minerals direct loans (OBBBA-funded)** — Direct lending for critical minerals production and related industries funded by OBBBA mandatory appropriations *($500M credit subsidy supporting up to $100B in critical-minerals loans (P.L. 119-21 sec. 20004, July 2025); FY2026 appropriations added ~$97.8M subsidy (~$4.4B volume); total OSC lending capacity >$210B per Director Lorch)*
- **Loan guarantees and technical assistance** — Authorized alongside direct loans under the FY2024 NDAA pilot (capital assistance to eligible entities such as corporations and joint ventures), subject to availability of appropriations

TRACK RECORD

OSC closed its first direct loan in August 2025: $150 million to MP Materials to add heavy rare-earth separation capability at Mountain Pass, CA, roughly seven months after its first funding notice opened in January 2025. It has since signed large conditional loan commitments concentrated in the rare-earth/critical-minerals supply chain: ~$700 million to Vulcan Elements ($620M) and ReElement Technologies ($80M) as part of a $1.4 billion public-private magnet supply-chain package (Nov 2025), $500 million to Phoenix Tailings for its 'Freedom Facility' rare-earth midstream plant (June 16, 2026), and $725 million to Energy Fuels for White Mesa Mill expansion and a rare-earth metals/alloy facility (June 18, 2026). Committed/announced volume is therefore in the low single-digit billions, with only the MP loan fully closed among the publicly confirmed transactions as of mid-2026.

MANDATE

Statutory purpose under 10 U.S.C. 149 and the FY2024 NDAA pilot: attract and scale private capital for national-security-critical technologies and supply chains by providing capital assistance (loans, loan guarantees, technical assistance) for dual-use technologies within covered technology categories defined in statute (e.g., advanced manufacturing, quantum sensing, space launch, critical minerals processing).

CAN'T / CONSTRAINTS

OSC cannot make grants or (under its own pilot authority) take equity — it is a credit program limited to loans, loan guarantees, and technical assistance for eligible entities in the statutory covered-technology categories, subject to Federal Credit Reform Act budgeting and available credit-subsidy appropriations. Its pilot program authority expires October 1, 2028, and lending is capped by appropriated subsidy (originally $984M capacity; OBBBA capacity is restricted to critical minerals production and related industries).

WANTS

2025-2026 priorities center on rebuilding the domestic critical-minerals and rare-earth 'mine-to-magnet' supply chain. P.L. 119-21 (July 2025) made OSC a ~$200 billion lender; leadership targets loans of $1-5 billion, and the FY2027 budget request seeks more than $20 billion in additional loan volume.

⚠ Pilot program authority under the FY2024 NDAA expires October 1, 2028; capacity depends on credit-subsidy appropriations. CRS (May 2026) flagged no FY2026 investment strategy released as of May 1, 2026, and Congress is weighing added reporting/transparency requirements. The ~$200 billion scaling WAS enacted in July 2025 (P.L. 119-21).

USIA angle — The scaled co-lender: ~$200B+ in lending authority (2025) aimed at exactly our sectors — dual-use tech and critical minerals — targeting $1-5B checks. Bring them in early, share credit publicly, and pair OSC debt with sovereign-pool equity and CHIPS/DPA grants for full stacks.

NOT FULLY VERIFIED

Exact date David A. Lorch became OSC Director and whether his appointment carries any 'acting' qualifier — he is quoted as 'Director' in June 2026 official releases, but no formal appointment announcement was located; Patrick Witt was Acting Director as of Aug 2025; Identity of OSC's deputy director / operational deputy — no public listing verified; OSC's FY2026 appropriation level — DefenseScoop reported the program was 'allotted less than $1.5 billion for fiscal 2026,' not independently verified against budget documents; Exact count of statutory covered technology categories (CRS versions cite ~31-34; May 2026 CRS summary says 34); Loan size limits in the initial $984M NOFA (reported elsewhere as $10M-$150M per loan) — not re-verified

Defense Production Act Title III program (DoD Defense Production Act Investments / DPA Purchases), Office of the Assistant Secretary of Defense for Industrial Base Policy

Michael P. Cadenazzi Jr. — Assistant Secretary of Defense (War) for Industrial Base Policy

WHERE IT SITS

Sits within the Office of the Under Secretary of Defense (War) for Acquisition and Sustainment under the Senate-confirmed Assistant Secretary for Industrial Base Policy (Cadenazzi, confirmed 52-47, sworn in Sept 23, 2025); it executes presidential DPA authorities delegated to DoD and is funded through the annual Defense Production Act Purchases appropriation plus mandatory reconciliation (OBBBA) funds.

WORKING LEVEL

Jeffrey Frankston, Acting Deputy Assistant Secretary of War for Industrial Base Resilience (oversees the Manufacturing Capability Expansion & Investment Prioritization directorate, which runs the DPA Purchases/DPA Investments office), per Feb 2026 DoW release

FIREPOWER

- **Purchases, purchase commitments, grants/other financial assistance (DPA sec. 303)** — Direct investments to create, maintain, or expand domestic productive capacity for essential materials and technologies *(FY2026 request: $265.9 million for DPA Purchases ($236.9M discretionary + $29.0M mandatory reconciliation for strategic/critical minerals))*
- **OBBBA critical-minerals investments (Industrial Base Fund via DPA Title III)** — Mining, processing, refining, and supply-chain integration projects executed primarily through Title III authorities and the Defense Industrial Base Consortium OTA *($5 billion appropriated by P.L. 119-21 sec. 20004 (July 2025), part of $7.5 billion total OBBBA critical-minerals funding to DoD)*
- **Loans and loan guarantees (DPA secs. 301-302)** — Authorized but rarely used financing tools; government-wide only one Title III loan (a $410M loan in 2023 for vaccine/critical-medicine manufacturing capacity) in FY2018-2024
- **Equity-style investment (Title III authority)** — Purchase of preferred stock — used for the July 2025 MP Materials transaction making DoD the company's largest shareholder *($400 million (July 2025))*

TRACK RECORD

GAO found that in FY2018-2024, Title III was used by DoD, HHS, and DOE for 222 investments plus one loan totaling $3.6 billion, with DoD making 208 of those investments (COVID response and strategic/critical materials). In 2025-2026 DoD's marquee Title III action was the July 2025 MP Materials package ($400M preferred-equity purchase, paired with a $150M OSC loan), followed by a steady cadence of smaller awards: ~$27M for U.S. antimony production, $11.8M for domestic critical-materials processing (Feb 2026), $27.3 million to PacSci EMC (Apr 2026) and $32.7 million to Systima Technologies and R.E. Darling for solid rocket motor capacity, plus a March 2026 Defense Industrial Base Consortium request for proposals beginning execution of the $5 billion OBBBA critical-minerals fund. Typical individual awards run $10M-$100M+ and take months from solicitation to award.

MANDATE

Title III of the Defense Production Act of 1950 (50 U.S.C. 4531-4534) directs incentives — loans, loan guarantees, purchases, purchase commitments, and other financial assistance — to create, maintain, protect, expand, or restore domestic industrial base capabilities essential for national defense, funded through the DPA Fund.

CAN'T / CONSTRAINTS

Title III actions require a nondelegable presidential determination that the resource is essential, industry cannot supply it timely without action, and the action is the most cost-effective alternative; if actions under one determination exceed $50 million in aggregate, prior congressional authorization and a 30-day committee notification are required (waivable during declared national emergencies). Assistance is limited to 'domestic sources' — businesses performing substantially all relevant work in the United States or Canada, with the United Kingdom and Australia added for Title III purposes — and the underlying DPA authorities currently expire September 30, 2026.

WANTS

2025-2026 priorities per budget documents, leadership statements (ASD Cadenazzi), and award flow: executing the $5 billion OBBBA critical-minerals mandate (mine-to-magnet rare earths, antimony, gallium, battery materials), expanding solid rocket motor and munitions/energetics capacity, and reducing reliance on Chinese supply chains across the defense industrial base.

⚠ DPA authorities lapsed October-November 2025 after expiring September 30, 2025 (delaying transactions), were extended to January 30, 2026 by P.L. 119-37, then to September 30, 2026 by the FY2026 NDAA (P.L. 119-60) — a multiyear reauthorization remains pending before Congress, so authorities again face a September 30, 2026 cliff.

USIA angle — Fastest discretionary grant path when a defense nexus exists; the presidential-determination route rewards exactly the White House alignment USIA can deliver. Our speed lever for critical-minerals gap-filling.

NOT FULLY VERIFIED

Identity of the DPA Title III program office director below the DASD level — not publicly verified; Whether the Air Force Research Laboratory still serves as Title III executive agent for contracting (historically true; not re-verified for 2026, and many recent awards run through the Defense Industrial Base Consortium OTA); Exact statutory authority mix used for the $400M MP Materials preferred-stock purchase — widely reported as DPA Title III but the transaction structure has not been fully disclosed; Jeffrey Frankston's acting status as of July 2026 (sourced from a Feb 2026 release snippet)

Industrial Base Analysis and Sustainment (IBAS) Program, Office of the Assistant Secretary of Defense for Industrial Base Policy

Dr. Kristin Schaaf — Acting Director, Innovation Capability and Modernization (ICAM) Office and Acting Director, Industrial Base Analysis and Sustainment (IBAS) Program **(acting)**

WHERE IT SITS

A program (not an agency) run by the career-led ICAM office within the Deputy Assistant Secretary for Industrial Base Resilience organization, under the Senate-confirmed Assistant Secretary of Defense (War) for Industrial Base Policy in OUSD(A&S); its director is a career official requiring no Senate confirmation, and it is funded through the OSD RDT&E budget line PE 0607210D8Z (Industrial Base Analysis and Sustainment Support) drawing on Industrial Base Fund authority.

FIREPOWER

- **Grants, OTAs, and contracts (assistance listing 12.750)** — Direct project funding to establish, expand, or sustain defense-critical industrial capabilities and workforce, largely awarded through the Cornerstone OTA administered by Army Contracting Command-Rock Island *(FY2026 budget request: $2,328.4 million for PE 0607210D8Z (a large increase over prior-year levels in the hundreds of millions))*
- **National Imperative for Industrial Skills (workforce initiative)** — Industrial workforce/talent-pipeline projects in defense-critical trades *(~$130 million across 16 workforce projects since 2020)*

TRACK RECORD

IBAS has funded hundreds of targeted industrial-base projects since 2014, with signature portfolios in castings and forgings, energetics and kinetic capabilities, hypersonics/solid rocket motors (e.g., X-Bow SRM capacity work), microelectronics, batteries, critical chemicals, and its National Imperative for Industrial Skills workforce initiative (~$130M across 16 projects since 2020). Individual awards typically run from single-digit to low-tens of millions and move through the Cornerstone/DIBC OTA vehicles faster than traditional procurement. Its budget line has grown sharply — the FY2026 request of roughly $2.3 billion reflects the administration's 2025-2026 critical-minerals and munitions industrial-base push.

MANDATE

Funded through the Industrial Base Fund (10 U.S.C. 4817, formerly 2508), IBAS must monitor and assess the defense industrial base, address critical capability shortfalls and supply-chain vulnerabilities, and sustain or expand domestic industrial capabilities essential to national defense.

CAN'T / CONSTRAINTS

IBAS is not a lending or equity program — it provides grants, OTA agreements, and contracts only, and its investments must tie to demonstrated defense industrial base shortfalls; it depends entirely on annual RDT&E appropriations (no mandatory funding stream of its own and no revolving capital). Awards flow to the domestic (U.S.) industrial base; it has no statutory sunset but also no standing multi-year capital authority.

WANTS

2025-2026 priorities per program briefings and the FY2026 request: scaling critical-minerals and critical-chemicals supply chains, munitions/energetics and solid rocket motor capacity, drone/uncrewed-systems and advanced manufacturing capability, and industrial workforce development through the talent-pipeline programs.

⚠ No statutory sunset or reauthorization requirement, but the program is wholly dependent on annual appropriations — the roughly $2.3 billion FY2026 request (a several-fold increase) was pending congressional action during 2025-2026, and the program was navigating a leadership transition after long-time director Adele Ratcliff's 2025 retirement (acting leadership as of mid-2026).

USIA angle — Small-check gap filler — de-risks a package's weakest link without reopening the whole stack. Cheap to ask, fast to move.

NOT FULLY VERIFIED

FY2024 and FY2025 enacted funding levels for PE 0607210D8Z — not verified in this research; Composition of the $2,328.4M FY2026 request (whether it consolidates critical-minerals or other industrial-base funding into the IBAS line) — single non-.gov source (HigherGov); Whether Dr. Schaaf remained acting IBAS/ICAM director in July 2026 or a permanent director was named after Adele Ratcliff's retirement; Whether the X-Bow solid rocket motor expansion was funded specifically by IBAS versus another industrial-base program; Identity of a deputy/second-in-command below Dr. Schaaf

Defense Logistics Agency — National Defense Stockpile (managed by DLA Strategic Materials)

Lt. Gen. Mark T. Simerly (USA) — Director, Defense Logistics Agency (National Defense Stockpile Manager is delegated to DLA)

WHERE IT SITS

Sits in the Department of Defense as a DoD combat support agency: DLA reports to the Under Secretary of Defense for Acquisition & Sustainment (stockpile policy via industrial base policy officials); the director is a three-star military officer (Senate-confirmed in rank, not a PAS civilian post); NDS operations are financed by the revolving National Defense Stockpile Transaction Fund (sales proceeds plus direct appropriations, most recently a $2B FY2025 appropriation in the One Big Beautiful Bill Act, Sec. 20004).

WORKING LEVEL

Eric J. Mata, Administrator, DLA Strategic Materials (runs day-to-day NDS acquisition/storage/disposition)

FIREPOWER

- **NDS Transaction Fund purchases** — Direct government purchase and physical stockpiling of strategic and critical materials *($2B appropriated by OBBBA (signed 2025-07-04) for critical-minerals acquisitions, on top of the existing revolving fund; DoD announced intent in 2025 to procure up to ~$1B of stockpile materials)*
- **Multi-year IDIQ offtake-style contracts** — Five-year indefinite-delivery contracts with domestic producers (e.g., up to $245M antimony IDIQ to United States Antimony Corp., Sept 2025; cobalt solicitation up to $500M; tantalum ~$100M; scandium ~$45M) *(Individual solicitations from ~$45M to $500M as of 2025-2026)*
- **Sales/rotations of excess materials** — Disposal of excess stockpile materials per the congressionally approved Annual Materials Plan *(Quantity-capped annually by the AMP; historically a revenue source, now de-emphasized in favor of accumulation)*

TRACK RECORD

Historically a Cold War legacy holder of a modest inventory (roughly $1-2B in materials) that mostly sold down excess for decades; since 2024-2025 it has pivoted sharply to buying. In 2025 DoD announced intent to procure up to $1B in stockpile materials, issued numerous RFIs (cobalt, bismuth, indium, niobium, scandium, tantalum, tungsten, graphite, samarium, dysprosium, terbium), awarded a five-year IDIQ worth up to $245M to United States Antimony Corp. (first $10M delivery order Sept 2025), and issued then withdrew (Oct 2025, for rework) an up-to-$500M high-purity cobalt solicitation. The OBBBA's $2B infusion (July 2025) is by far the largest stockpile funding in decades and purchases under it continued into 2026.

MANDATE

Under the Strategic and Critical Materials Stock Piling Act (50 U.S.C. 98 et seq.), the NDS must acquire and retain strategic and critical materials to preclude a dangerous and costly dependence on foreign sources of supply in time of national emergency; DoD is the designated stockpile manager and DLA executes via an annual materials plan.

CAN'T / CONSTRAINTS

By statute the stockpile may be used only for national defense purposes and expressly may not be used for economic or budgetary purposes; releases require presidential/statutory direction, disposals require congressional (NDAA) authorization, annual acquisition/disposal quantities are capped by the congressionally reviewed Annual Materials Plan, and a Market Impact Committee (co-chaired by State and Commerce) must vet transactions to avoid undue market disruption.

WANTS

2025-2026 priorities: rapidly rebuild inventories of critical minerals exposed to Chinese export controls (antimony, gallium, germanium, rare earths, cobalt), obligate the OBBBA $2B through multi-year purchase contracts that double as demand signals for domestic producers, and expand coverage to materials with U.S. deposits but weak domestic processing (scandium, tungsten, graphite).

⚠ No charter expiration, but acquisitions/disposals depend on annual NDAA/AMP authorizations; leadership transition pending — Lt. Gen. Simerly retires December 2026 and Maj. Gen. (promotable) David Sanford was announced in June 2026 as his replacement; execution risk noted in 2025-2026 reporting (e.g., canceled/reworked cobalt solicitation).

USIA angle — The offtake/price-floor lever. Demand certainty replaces billions in subsidy for commodity-exposed minerals deals — bring DLA a standardized floor structure instead of negotiating bespoke each time.

NOT FULLY VERIFIED

Exact period of availability of the OBBBA $2B NDS appropriation (FY2025 appropriation; whether it remains available through FY2029 like the companion $5B Industrial Base Fund money was not directly verified); Current NDS Transaction Fund balance and total inventory value as of mid-2026; Whether the withdrawn $500M cobalt solicitation had been reissued as of July 2026; Eric Mata's continued tenure as Administrator as of July 2026 (DLA bio page and a July 2026 trade-press article support it, but no leadership-change search was run specifically)

U.S. Department of Energy Office of Energy Dominance Financing (EDF; formerly the Loan Programs Office)

Gregory (Greg) A. Beard — Director, Office of Energy Dominance Financing (effective Jan 29, 2026)

WHERE IT SITS

Sits inside the Department of Energy; its director is appointed by the Secretary of Energy (not Senate-confirmed) and reports up through DOE leadership to Secretary Chris Wright; lending capacity comes from statutory loan-guarantee/direct-loan authorities (Title XVII of EPAct 2005, ATVM, Tribal energy) with credit-subsidy costs covered by appropriations — most recently $1B for the Energy Dominance Financing program in the OBBBA — or borrower-paid fees.

FIREPOWER

- **Energy Dominance Financing program (Sec. 1706, rebranded EIR)** — Loan guarantees for projects that retool, repower, replace, or add capacity to energy infrastructure — expanded by OBBBA to cover coal/gas generation, nuclear, grid, and critical-minerals supply chains *(Up to $250B total principal through Sept 30, 2028, with $1B OBBBA credit subsidy (est. to support roughly $200B+ of financing); office-wide loan authority reported at ~$289B as of Feb 2026)*
- **Title 17 Sec. 1703 innovative energy loan guarantees** — Guarantees for projects deploying new or significantly improved energy technology *(Sharply reduced — OBBBA rescinded unobligated IRA credit-subsidy funding for the Title 17 clean-energy program (remaining capacity limited/uncertain as of mid-2026))*
- **Advanced Technology Vehicles Manufacturing (ATVM) direct loans** — Direct loans for U.S. manufacturing of advanced vehicles and components *(Authority survives but OBBBA rescinded unobligated IRA credit subsidy; new-lending capacity limited as of 2025-2026)*
- **Tribal Energy Finance Program** — Partial loan guarantees/direct loans for energy development by tribes *(Authority retained; scale post-OBBBA not well documented publicly)*

TRACK RECORD

Since 2005 the office has closed tens of billions in loans (Tesla, Ford, the Vogtle nuclear guarantees, and a ~$100B wave of closings/conditional commitments in late 2024). Under the second Trump administration it reviewed and pared back Biden-era commitments (canceling the $4.9B Grain Belt Express transmission guarantee in July 2025) while continuing disbursements on the ~$1.5B Palisades nuclear-restart loan across at least five tranches in 2025. In its EDF era it issued a conditional commitment of up to $17.5B in American Nuclear Supply Chain Loans (announced June 23, 2026) to finance long-lead equipment for up to 10 Westinghouse AP1000 reactors at five sites, plus an up-to-$263M conditional commitment to SHINE for a medical-isotope plant.

MANDATE

Statutorily charged under Title XVII of the Energy Policy Act of 2005 (Secs. 1703 and 1706 as amended by IRA and OBBBA), EISA Sec. 136 (ATVM), and tribal energy authorities to provide debt financing that commercial lenders will not, for energy infrastructure, innovative technology, and (post-OBBBA) energy-security and critical-minerals projects; every loan must have a reasonable prospect of repayment.

CAN'T / CONSTRAINTS

Cannot finance projects lacking a reasonable prospect of repayment; guaranteed debt is generally capped at 80% of project costs; Sec. 1703 is restricted to new-or-significantly-improved technologies; the EDF/Sec. 1706 commitment authority expires September 30, 2028; credit subsidy must be appropriated or paid by borrowers, and the OBBBA rescissions removed most IRA-era subsidy for the non-EDF windows.

WANTS

2025-2026 stated priorities (Secretary Wright, Director Beard): finance power capacity for the AI race and grid reliability, rebuild the commercial nuclear industry (AP1000 fleet, restart projects), secure critical-minerals supply chains, and open eligibility to coal and oil-and-gas-fired generation under the 'energy dominance' banner.

⚠ EDF (Sec. 1706) commitment authority sunsets Sept 30, 2028; the October 28, 2025 interim final rule implementing EDF drew GAO review (B-338008) and legal scrutiny; ongoing litigation/dispute risk from restructured or canceled Biden-era loans and conditional commitments; annual appropriations still needed for administrative expenses and any new credit subsidy.

USIA angle — The senior-debt partner for energy, nuclear, and minerals-with-an-energy-nexus: LPO leverage stretches every sovereign-pool equity dollar and their underwriting is real diligence our deals benefit from. They are slow — engage at deal intake, not at structuring, and never promise LPO terms before LPO does. Also our best detailee bench — already producing people.

NOT FULLY VERIFIED

The ~$289B office-wide loan-authority figure (single press figure from Feb 2026 reporting; not verified against a DOE monthly portfolio report); Precise remaining capacity of the 1703, ATVM, and Tribal windows after OBBBA rescissions (energy.gov pages returned 403 to fetch); Identity/title of the current deputy or chief operating official under Beard (a Joshua Moraczewski appears on EDF staff pages but title unverified); Exact completion date of the Palisades restart (disbursements verified through Aug 2025; widely reported restart in fall 2025 not independently re-verified here); Leadership sequence detail: Lane Genatowski's exact departure date between his mid-2025 appointment and Beard's Jan 29, 2026 start

DOE Office of Manufacturing & Energy Supply Chains (MESC) and Office of Clean Energy Demonstrations (OCED) — both absorbed into the Office of Critical Minerals and Energy Innovation (CMEI) in DOE's Nov 20, 2025 reorganization

Audrey Robertson — Assistant Secretary of Energy leading the Office of Critical Minerals and Energy Innovation (Senate-confirmed Oct 7, 2025, 51-47, as Assistant Secretary for Energy Efficiency and Renewable Energy)

WHERE IT SITS

Both were DOE program offices funded overwhelmingly by Bipartisan Infrastructure Law and IRA appropriations; as of the November 20, 2025 DOE reorganization their functions sit in CMEI (alongside former EERE technology offices and FECM minerals projects), led by a Senate-confirmed Assistant Secretary answering to Secretary of Energy Chris Wright.

WORKING LEVEL

Christopher Saldaña, Deputy Assistant Secretary for Critical Minerals, Materials, and Manufacturing (CM3 pillar, which holds the former MESC portfolio); Michael Helmer is Principal Deputy Assistant Secretary of CMEI

FIREPOWER

- **BIL Sec. 40207 battery materials processing & battery manufacturing/recycling grants (ex-MESC)** — 50%-cost-share grants to build domestic battery-materials and cell/component manufacturing *(~$6B appropriated; roughly $3B awarded in round 1 (Oct 2022) and up to ~$3B selected in round 2 (Sept 2024); ~$725M third round re-scoped in Jan 2025 toward critical-materials processing)*
- **OCED demonstration cooperative agreements** — At-scale, ~50% cost-share demonstrations (regional clean hydrogen hubs, industrial demonstrations, carbon capture and DAC hubs, long-duration storage) *(Originally $21.5B+ from BIL plus IRA industrial funds; gutted in 2025 — OCED accounted for roughly $12.4B of canceled awards across 61 projects, and FY2026 appropriations provided OCED nothing)*
- **Critical materials / manufacturing funding opportunities under CMEI** — Grants and cooperative agreements refocused on critical minerals processing, batteries, and magnets (e.g., 'Strengthening Domestic Critical Materials Processing and Manufacturing' NOI) *(Hundreds of millions per opportunity as of 2025-2026 (e.g., ~$725M NOI))*

TRACK RECORD

MESC actually awarded roughly $3B in first-round battery grants (Oct 2022, ~20 firms) and selected up to ~$3B more in Sept 2024, plus IRA Defense Production Act heat-pump awards; in 2025 the office reopened funding refocused on critical-materials processing. OCED selected seven H2Hubs ($7B), ~33 industrial demonstration projects (~$6B), and DAC hubs, but in 2025 Secretary Wright terminated 24 awards worth $3.7B (May) and, on Oct 2, 2025, 321 awards across 223 projects worth $7.5B — with OCED bearing ~$12.4B in total cancellations including all hydrogen and DAC hubs. Both offices were then abolished as standalone organizations in the Nov 20, 2025 reorganization, with surviving programs moved into CMEI, which was split into three DAS-led pillars in January 2026.

MANDATE

OCED was congressionally established by the 2021 Bipartisan Infrastructure Law with $21.5B+ to conduct at-scale demonstrations of emerging energy technologies; MESC was stood up administratively in 2022 to execute BIL/IRA manufacturing and supply-chain provisions (battery grants, industrial programs, supply-chain analysis). CMEI now carries the statutory obligations attached to those appropriated programs.

CAN'T / CONSTRAINTS

Grant programs are bound to their appropriated statutory purposes: battery grants require ~50% non-federal cost share and exclude foreign entities of concern, and demonstration awards carry EPAct 2005 Sec. 988 cost-share requirements; the executive cannot lawfully repurpose or withhold funds Congress appropriated to OCED-specific programs — the basis of ongoing impoundment/illegal-elimination claims by House Science Democrats and litigation by terminated awardees.

WANTS

2025-2026 priorities under Robertson/CMEI: critical-minerals 'mine-to-magnet' supply chains, battery and magnet manufacturing, processing and metallurgy innovation, and recycling — reframed around energy dominance, affordability, and national security rather than decarbonization; demonstration spending is being steered toward nuclear, geothermal, and grid-supporting technologies.

⚠ Major restructuring already executed: MESC and OCED eliminated as standalone offices Nov 20, 2025; FY2026 appropriations zeroed OCED; the January 2026 CMEI three-pillar realignment is still settling; and the ~$12B+ in 2025 award terminations plus the office elimination face congressional challenges and litigation that could force partial reinstatement.

USIA angle — Grant partner for batteries, grid, and energy supply chains — but appropriations-round timing dictates when our deals can catch their money. Track their calendar like a market window.

NOT FULLY VERIFIED

Whether CMEI reports directly to the Secretary or through an Under Secretary in the post-Nov-2025 DOE chain of command; Exact dollar totals actually obligated (vs. selected/announced) under MESC battery grant rounds 1-2 and how much survived 2025 award reviews; Precise statutory citation for OCED's establishment (BIL provision, commonly codified around 42 U.S.C. 18861) — not independently re-verified; Current status/disposition of surviving OCED awards (e.g., remaining hydrogen hubs, industrial demonstrations) inside CMEI as of July 2026; Whether Audrey Robertson's CMEI role rests solely on her Senate confirmation as Assistant Secretary for EERE (no separate confirmation for a 'CMEI' post was found); Verifier (capacity): corrected — The $6B BIL Sec. 40207 appropriation, ~$2.8-3B round 1 (Oct 2022, originally 20 projects; later reduced to ~$1.82B/14 projects after cancellations) and $3B+ round 2 (Sept 2024, 25 projects) are accurate, but the third-round description is outdated and conflated: the Jan 10, 2025 NOI (~$725M) was the original battery-focused third round issued under the Biden administration; the re-scope toward critical-materials processing occurred later and culminated in a NOFO of up to $500 million announced March 13, 2026 by CMEI's Manufacturing Deployment Office (covering critical minerals/materials processing, battery manufacturing, and recycling). As of July 2026 the third round stands at up to $500M, not ~$725M.

U.S. International Development Finance Corporation (DFC)

Benjamin (Ben) Black — Chief Executive Officer

WHERE IT SITS

Independent executive-branch development finance agency created by the BUILD Act of 2018; its CEO is Senate-confirmed (Black confirmed October 2025) and answers to a board of directors chaired by the Secretary of State, and it runs on annual appropriations plus offsetting collections from a largely self-sustaining portfolio, under a statutory maximum-contingent-liability ceiling raised to $205 billion in December 2025.

WORKING LEVEL

Conor Coleman, Chief of Staff and Head of Investments (the Senate-confirmed Deputy CEO post appears vacant as of mid-2026)

FIREPOWER

- **Debt financing (direct loans and guaranties)** — Project and corporate loans/guaranties to private-sector-led projects in developing countries, historically up to about $1 billion per project *(Shares the $205 billion aggregate exposure ceiling (raised from $60 billion by the FY26 NDAA, signed 2025-12-18); total portfolio exposure was $43.4 billion across 103 countries as of 2025-09-30)*
- **Equity investments** — Direct minority equity stakes, with ownership authority raised to up to 40% of a project by the 2025 reauthorization *(New $5 billion equity revolving fund at Treasury authorized in the FY26 NDAA (December 2025) to relieve budget-scoring constraints; funding subject to appropriations)*
- **Political risk insurance** — Coverage against expropriation, political violence, and currency inconvertibility, historically up to about $1 billion per project *(Within the $205 billion aggregate ceiling (as of 2025-12))*
- **Investment funds** — Capital commitments to private investment funds targeting developing markets
- **Technical assistance and feasibility studies** — Small grants to develop bankable projects alongside its financing

TRACK RECORD

DFC hit a record of roughly $12 billion in new commitments in FY2024, then slowed sharply to about $3.6 billion across 30 transactions in FY2025 amid the administration transition and the October-December 2025 authorization lapse; total exposure stood at $43.4 billion in 103 countries as of September 30, 2025. Under CEO Black the 2025-2026 signature moves are critical-minerals and strategic-infrastructure plays: a $600 million contribution to the $1.8 billion Orion Critical Minerals Consortium (with a further $900 million board-approved), a signed loan agreement for the Lobito Atlantic Railway (DRC-Zambia-Angola corridor), standing up the U.S.-Ukraine Reconstruction Investment Fund, and June 2026 board approvals including $1.5 billion for energy infrastructure across South and Southeast Asia and roughly $2.5 billion in strategic investments.

MANDATE

Under the BUILD Act of 2018, DFC must mobilize private capital for development-oriented investment in less-developed countries in support of U.S. foreign policy, complementing rather than competing with private finance. The DFC Modernization and Reauthorization Act of 2025 (enacted in the FY26 NDAA, P.L. 119-60, December 18, 2025) renewed and broadened this mandate through 2031 with a more explicit economic-statecraft/strategic-competition orientation.

CAN'T / CONSTRAINTS

It cannot invest in roughly the world's 20 wealthiest countries, and no more than 10% of its $205 billion ceiling may be used in high-income countries; equity must remain minority positions (now up to 40% ownership). Total exposure is capped at $205 billion, and it is directed not to crowd out available private-sector financing.

WANTS

CEO Black's stated 2025-2026 agenda is 'economic statecraft': securing critical-mineral and rare-earth supply chains, financing energy (including U.S. LNG-linked infrastructure) and strategic ports/corridors, countering China, and delivering a return to taxpayers. The administration's FY2026 budget requested about $3.8 billion for DFC (roughly a 280% increase over FY2025), and the agency is focused on operationalizing its new $205 billion cap and $5 billion equity revolving fund.

⚠ Its BUILD Act authorization lapsed on October 6, 2025 and was restored on December 18, 2025 when the FY26 NDAA reauthorized DFC through 2031 (reported as December 31, 2031), so no near-term charter cliff remains; the main open risk is appropriations — the $5 billion equity revolving fund and the enlarged program depend on annual funding.

USIA angle — Covers the upstream links abroad that feed our domestic plants — the mine behind our refinery. Newly reauthorized (Dec 2025) with a $205B ceiling and an economic-statecraft agenda that mirrors ours; eager for strategically legible wins. Watch domestic-adjacent authorities as either partner or turf.

NOT FULLY VERIFIED

Ben Black's exact Senate confirmation date (October 7, 2025) comes from a search snippet of his dfc.gov bio; direct fetches of dfc.gov and congress.gov were blocked (HTTP 403 via proxy) so the page text could not be read in full.; Exact reauthorization sunset date of December 31, 2031 is from secondary summaries (CGD/press); the statutory text was not read directly.; The ~$1 billion per-project ceilings for DFC loans and political risk insurance reflect long-standing DFC practice/marketing and pre-reauthorization CRS descriptions; whether the 2025 reauthorization changed per-project limits was not verified.; Deputy CEO vacancy is per Wikipedia's DFC article only; Conor Coleman's exact current title (Chief of Staff and Head of Investments) is from a Devex interview and search snippets, not an official org chart read directly.; The '10% of the ceiling in high-income countries' and 'excluded ~20 wealthiest countries' eligibility rules are from think-tank summaries (Atlantic Council/DFRLab/CGD) of the NDAA text, not the statute itself.; June 2026 board-approval figures ($1.5B Asia energy; $2.5B strategic investments) are from press-release headlines surfaced in search; full release text was not readable.

Export-Import Bank of the United States (EXIM)

John Jovanovic — President and Chairman of the Board of Directors

WHERE IT SITS

Independent executive-branch agency serving as the official U.S. export credit agency; its President/Chairman is Senate-confirmed to a fixed term (Jovanovic confirmed 51-47 on September 18, 2025, term expiring January 20, 2029) and chairs a five-member Senate-confirmed board (Commerce Secretary and USTR sit ex officio), and the bank is self-financing from interest and fees — appropriations only set administrative-expense limits — under a $135 billion statutory exposure cap.

WORKING LEVEL

James G. Burrows, Acting First Vice President and Vice Chairman of the Board (appointed in an acting capacity by the President in March 2025; a career EXIM small-business banking executive)

FIREPOWER

- **Direct loans** — Medium- and long-term fixed-rate loans to foreign buyers of U.S. exports (e.g., the $4.7 billion Mozambique LNG direct loan) *(Within the $135 billion statutory exposure cap; total portfolio exposure was $34.8 billion as of 2025-09-30, leaving roughly $100 billion of headroom)*
- **Loan guarantees** — Guarantees of commercial-bank financing to creditworthy foreign buyers of U.S. goods and services *(Within the $135 billion cap; FY2025 total authorizations across all products were $8.7 billion supporting an estimated $10.1 billion in exports)*
- **Export credit insurance** — Short- and medium-term insurance protecting exporters against foreign-buyer nonpayment *($2.4 billion in short-term policies authorized in FY2025, of which $1.1 billion for small businesses)*
- **Working capital guarantees / domestic financing (Make More in America)** — Guarantees of exporters' working-capital lending plus domestic project financing for export-oriented U.S. manufacturing
- **China and Transformational Exports Program (CTEP)** — Enhanced-terms financing to counter Chinese export credit in 10 transformational sectors (semiconductors, AI, biotech, renewable energy, etc.) *(20% of total financing authority (about $27 billion) reserved by the 2019 charter reauthorization (not re-verified this session))*
- **Strategic supply chain initiative** — Announced November 2025 plan to make available up to $100 billion for critical minerals, nuclear power, and natural gas supply chains for the U.S. and allies, including a roughly $4 billion Egypt gas guarantee *(Up to $100 billion (announced 2025-11; a plan/pipeline, not yet closed authorizations))*

TRACK RECORD

In FY2025 EXIM authorized $8.7 billion in financing supporting an estimated $10.1 billion of U.S. exports, including $1.7 billion (19.4%) for small business, with exposure of $34.8 billion across 138 markets as of September 30, 2025. The signature 2025 transaction was the board's unanimous March 13, 2025 vote to proceed with the amended $4.7 billion direct loan for the TotalEnergies Mozambique LNG project after a four-year delay; the project's sponsors announced a full restart in January 2026. In November 2025 Jovanovic launched the up-to-$100 billion strategic supply chains push (critical minerals, nuclear, natural gas), and the restored three-member board quorum (via March 2025 acting appointments) has allowed large transactions to move after years of gridlock risk.

MANDATE

Under the Export-Import Bank Act of 1945 (its charter), EXIM must support U.S. jobs by financing exports the private sector will not support on competitive terms — supplementing, not competing with, private capital — while maintaining reasonable assurance of repayment and countering foreign government export-credit competition. The charter also directs it to make a share of authority available to small business (statutory target of 25%) and to reserve 20% of financing authority for the China and Transformational Exports Program.

CAN'T / CONSTRAINTS

Its charter authority expires December 31, 2026 absent reauthorization, and a statutory 2% portfolio default-rate cap freezes new lending if breached. Support is conditioned on U.S.-content and U.S.-flag shipping rules, is generally barred for military/defense exports and for deals that would substantially harm U.S. industry (economic-impact rules), cannot exceed the $135 billion exposure cap, and larger transactions (historically those above $10 million) require approval by a three-member board quorum.

WANTS

In March 2026 reauthorization testimony before Senate Banking and House Financial Services, Jovanovic asked Congress for three things: a reauthorized charter including CTEP, relief from the constraints of the 2% default-rate cap, and hiring flexibility for specialized talent. The bank's stated strategic priorities (FY2025 annual report 'Winning Globally in America's Golden Age' and the November 2025 announcement) are countering China and financing critical minerals, nuclear power, and natural gas/LNG supply chains, with up to $100 billion earmarked for that push.

⚠ Charter expires December 31, 2026; reauthorization is actively pending in Congress as of mid-2026 (Jovanovic testified to Senate Banking and House Financial Services in March 2026; Senate Banking Chairman Scott is pushing a bill, while Sen. Warren raised transparency objections in June 2026). Secondary risks: two of five board seats vacant with the vice chairman serving in an acting capacity, and the 2% default-rate cap could freeze lending if breached.

USIA angle — Domestic financing with an export nexus (Make More in America) and the anti-PRC financing window (CTEP). Charter pressure makes them motivated to show strategic relevance — our deals are their story. Content rules bite; check eligibility early.

NOT FULLY VERIFIED

The $10 million board-approval threshold for transactions is from widely reported coverage of the 2015-2019 quorum lapse and was not re-verified against the current charter this session.; The 25% small-business statutory target and the 20%/$27 billion CTEP set-aside are from prior CRS knowledge; FY2025 actual small-business share (19.4%) is verified, the statutory percentages were not re-read in the charter text.; Current board composition detail (two director vacancies; Spencer Bachus III as remaining Senate-confirmed director; Burrows still acting as of July 2026) is from search snippets of exim.gov leadership pages, which could not be fetched directly (HTTP 403 via proxy).; FY2025 jobs-supported figure could not be found.; Whether the up-to-$100 billion supply-chain initiative has produced closed authorizations beyond announcements/letters of interest could not be verified.

U.S. Trade and Development Agency (USTDA)

Thomas R. Hardy — Deputy Director and Chief Operating Officer, performing the duties of the Director **(acting)**

WHERE IT SITS

Independent federal agency in the foreign-affairs cluster, operating under the foreign policy guidance of the Secretary of State; its Director is a Senate-confirmed presidential appointee (post currently filled in an acting capacity), and it is funded through the State, Foreign Operations appropriations bill (about $87 million per year).

WORKING LEVEL

Thomas R. Hardy doubles as the operational lead (career official, at USTDA since 1988; Acting Director Jan-Nov 2025); no separate Senate-confirmed Director identified, and no pending Director nomination found in the 119th Congress.

FIREPOWER

- **Project preparation grants** — Grants to overseas project sponsors for feasibility studies, technical assistance and pilot projects that tie emerging-market infrastructure projects to U.S. goods and services *(Funded from a total agency appropriation of $87.0 million in FY2024 and FY2025; FY2026 request also $87 million (agency operating under FY2026 continuing appropriations); individual grants are typically low seven figures)*
- **Reverse trade missions** — Brings foreign infrastructure decision-makers to the U.S. to meet American suppliers (2026 missions planned on grid security and midstream gas infrastructure) *(Within the same ~$87M annual appropriation)*
- **Global Procurement Initiative / training grants** — Trains foreign procurement officials in best-value, life-cycle procurement practices that improve U.S. firms' competitiveness

TRACK RECORD

USTDA reported a near-record ten-year-average multiplier of $226 in U.S. exports per program dollar for FY2025 (after $231 in FY2024) and more than $127 billion in U.S. exports facilitated since 1992. It remained active through 2025-2026 — e.g., supporting Cote d'Ivoire's first major solar minigrid project and planning 2026 reverse trade missions on grid security and midstream gas — and was one of the only foreign-assistance agencies the Trump administration did not propose to cut or abolish in the FY2026 budget. Its interventions are small, early-stage and catalytic rather than deal-closing; export returns materialize over long infrastructure timelines.

MANDATE

Permanently authorized under Section 661 of the Foreign Assistance Act of 1961, as amended (22 U.S.C. 2421), to promote U.S. private-sector participation in development projects in developing and middle-income countries — an explicit dual export-promotion and development mandate carried out through project preparation and partnership-building activities.

CAN'T / CONSTRAINTS

It does not finance project construction — no loans, guarantees, equity or insurance (that is DFC/EXIM territory); it can only fund planning-stage activities and events, and its activities must be tied to countries eligible under its statute and appropriations. Grants are conditioned on the use of U.S. firms/technology, and its total programming is bounded by a small (~$87M) annual appropriation.

WANTS

Its FY2026 budget justification prioritizes U.S. 'energy dominance,' leadership in critical and emerging technologies, critical-minerals supply-chain development, and countering PRC economic influence in emerging markets. Pending FY2026 appropriations language (H.R. 4779) would let it work in any country where the U.S. has strategic foreign-policy or national-security interests, subject to congressional consultation.

⚠ No authorization cliff — permanently authorized — but no Senate-confirmed Director since January 2025, FY2026 funding is via continuing appropriations (P.L. 119-37), and proposed FY2026 approps language would materially broaden its country-eligibility rules; the agency also faced restructuring uncertainty during the 2025 foreign-aid reorganization, though its FY2026 request survived intact at $87M.

USIA angle — Small but useful upstream: feasibility and project-prep money for allied-supply-chain projects that feed our deals; cheap goodwill with partner governments.

NOT FULLY VERIFIED

Could not directly re-verify that Hardy is still performing the duties of the Director as of July 2026 (agency web pages were unreachable through the network proxy; the Nov 2025 title and a 2026 interview identifying him as Deputy Director are the latest evidence found).; Exact FY2026 enacted appropriation level (assumed continued at ~$87M under the FY2026 CR; full-year figure not confirmed).; Absence of a pending Director nomination is based on search results not surfacing one, not on an exhaustive nominations-database check.

Small Business Investment Company (SBIC) Program, U.S. Small Business Administration

Kelly Loeffler — Administrator, U.S. Small Business Administration (confirmed February 2025; testified before House Appropriations July 14, 2026)

WHERE IT SITS

A program of the SBA (independent agency; Administrator is Senate-confirmed and holds Cabinet rank in the current administration), run by the Office of Investment and Innovation; its capital comes from private investors in licensed funds plus SBA-guaranteed debentures sold to institutional investors with full-faith-and-credit backing, with the annual leverage ceiling set in appropriations acts and the program designed to operate at zero subsidy cost to taxpayers.

WORKING LEVEL

Joshua (Josh) Carter, Associate Administrator, SBA Office of Investment and Innovation — the office that licenses and oversees SBICs; testified before the House Small Business Committee June 25, 2026.

FIREPOWER

- **SBA-guaranteed debenture leverage** — Licensed private funds borrow up to roughly 2x their private capital at favorable rates via 100% SBA-guaranteed debentures *(Annual leverage commitment authorization of $5 billion (set for FY2023 and carried in subsequent appropriations); per-fund caps raised by the Investing in All of America Act (signed May 19, 2026) to $250M per fund / $475M per family of funds, from $175M/$350M)*
- **Bonus leverage exclusions** — Dollar-for-dollar exclusion from leverage caps for qualifying investments in rural small businesses, critical technologies, small manufacturers and low-income areas, up to the lesser of 50% of private capital or $125M (post-enactment investments only); leverage-increase requests due September 1, 2026 *(New authority as of May 2026)*
- **Accrual debentures** — Patient-capital debenture (interest accrues to maturity) created by the 2023 SBIC reforms to accommodate equity-oriented and long-duration funds, including the joint SBA-DoD SBICCT critical-technology initiative
- **Total program capital** — Combined private capital plus SBA leverage across all licensed SBICs *(Record $53 billion at FY2025 close, up from $46 billion in FY2024)*

TRACK RECORD

FY2025 was the program's largest year ever: $53 billion in combined private capital and SBA leverage (vs. $46B in FY2024), 48 new SBIC licenses approved, and a record 88 'green light' letters building a pipeline projected to drive roughly $27 billion of new private investment concentrated in manufacturing and critical technologies. A final rule modernizing SBIC regulations to channel capital toward critical industries took effect February 2, 2026, and the bipartisan Investing in All of America Act — House-passed unanimously December 1, 2025, Senate-cleared April 15, 2026, signed May 19, 2026 — sharply expanded leverage capacity. Licensing runs through a two-stage green-light/license process that historically takes many months, though SBA touts an accelerated pipeline.

MANDATE

Under the Small Business Investment Act of 1958, the program must stimulate and supplement the flow of private equity capital and long-term debt financing to U.S. small businesses by licensing, regulating and leveraging privately owned and managed investment funds — SBA provides guaranteed leverage, not direct investment.

CAN'T / CONSTRAINTS

SBA cannot invest directly in companies; capital flows only through licensed private funds, which must invest in U.S. small businesses meeting SBA size standards (with a required share to 'smaller enterprises') and are barred from financing passive businesses, re-lenders/re-investors, real estate and project finance, and most foreign operations. Leverage is capped per fund/family ($250M/$475M since May 2026, plus bounded exclusions) and by the annual government-wide leverage commitment level set in appropriations.

WANTS

Stated 2025-2026 priorities are steering SBIC capital into manufacturing, critical technologies, defense-industrial-base and rural/low-income investment (the January 2026 final rule and the Investing in All of America Act both explicitly target these), with Administrator Loeffler framing the program as part of an 'onshoring' and industrial-strength agenda; SBA expects to support roughly $6 billion in private capital through the program in FY2026.

⚠ No reauthorization cliff — permanently authorized under the 1958 Act with annual leverage levels set in appropriations; near-term dates are implementation of the February 2, 2026 final rule and the September 1, 2026 deadline for existing SBICs to request increased leverage under the new statutory caps.

USIA angle — Fund-level, not deal-level: SBIC leverage multiplies private capital into critical-tech funds. Pair with OSC for a two-agency answer when the right vehicle is a fund rather than a project.

NOT FULLY VERIFIED

Exact FY2025/FY2026 annual leverage commitment authorization: $5 billion is confirmed for FY2023 and believed carried forward, but the enacted FY2025/FY2026 figure was not directly verified.; The '$6 billion in private capital expected in FY2026' figure comes from a secondary summary of Loeffler's congressional testimony, not the primary transcript.; Josh Carter's exact start date and whether his Associate Administrator role is career or appointed could not be verified.; FY2025 SBA-leverage-only dollar commitments (as distinct from the $53B combined figure) were not verified.

U.S. Department of the Treasury (investment-relevant functions: 48D/45X/48C tax credit administration, CFIUS chairmanship, sovereign wealth fund initiative)

Scott Bessent — Secretary of the Treasury (confirmed January 2025; in office as of Senate Finance testimony and CFIUS correspondence in June 2026)

WHERE IT SITS

Cabinet executive department; the Senate-confirmed Secretary answers to the President, statutorily chairs CFIUS, and administers investment tax credits that operate as uncapped mandatory spending through the tax code rather than annual appropriations (Treasury/IRS write the rules and pay the credits, including elective-pay refunds).

WORKING LEVEL

Christopher Pilkerton, Assistant Secretary for Investment Security (leads CFIUS staff; confirmed by the Senate December 18, 2025). On tax administration, Kenneth Kies served as Assistant Secretary for Tax Policy from June 2025 but his departure was announced in July 2026.

FIREPOWER

- **Section 48D Advanced Manufacturing Investment Credit (CHIPS ITC)** — Investment tax credit for semiconductor and semiconductor-equipment manufacturing facilities, with direct-pay election; raised from 25% to 35% by the One Big Beautiful Bill Act (July 2025) for property placed in service after December 31, 2025 *(Uncapped (open-ended tax expenditure), but only for facilities whose construction begins before January 1, 2027)*
- **Section 45X Advanced Manufacturing Production Credit** — Per-unit production credit for U.S.-made batteries, solar and wind components, inverters and critical minerals (metallurgical coal added at 2.5% by OBBBA), now subject to prohibited-foreign-entity/'material assistance' restrictions *(Uncapped; wind components terminate after 2027 and most credits phase down starting 2030 and end after 2032)*
- **Section 48C Qualifying Advanced Energy Project Credit** — Competitively allocated 30% ITC for clean-energy manufacturing, recycling and industrial-decarbonization projects, run jointly with DOE *($10 billion cap fully allocated ($4B in March 2024, $6B announced January 2025); no remaining capacity, and OBBBA eliminated re-allocation of forfeited awards)*
- **CFIUS chairmanship** — Regulatory power (not dollars) to review, mitigate, or recommend blocking covered foreign investments, including negotiating national security agreements with structural conditions *(Not a funded instrument; leverage demonstrated by the June 2025 U.S. Steel golden-share NSA tied to $11 billion in committed Nippon Steel investment by 2028)*
- **U.S. sovereign wealth fund initiative (EO 14196)** — February 3, 2025 executive order directed Treasury and Commerce to deliver a plan for a U.S. sovereign wealth fund within 90 days *(No capital — the plan was submitted around May 2025, parts were rejected by the White House, and reporting indicates the formal SWF was shelved as a lower priority as of mid-2026; the administration pivoted to ad hoc direct equity stakes and golden shares instead)*

TRACK RECORD

Treasury/IRS fully allocated the $10B Section 48C program across two rounds (March 2024 and January 2025) and administer the uncapped 48D and 45X credits that have supported the post-CHIPS/IRA semiconductor and clean-manufacturing build-out, with OBBBA (signed July 4, 2025) raising 48D to 35% while layering foreign-entity restrictions onto 45X. As CFIUS chair, Bessent's Treasury ran the de novo re-review that reversed the January 2025 prohibition of Nippon Steel's acquisition of U.S. Steel, closing it in June 2025 under an unprecedented national security agreement featuring a U.S. government golden share and $11B in committed investment, implementing the February 2025 'America First Investment Policy' memorandum (fast-track for allies, tighter scrutiny of China-linked deals); in 2026 senators pressed CFIUS to review the Paramount-Warner Bros. transaction over foreign sovereign-wealth capital. The sovereign-wealth-fund plan Bessent co-authored with Commerce Secretary Lutnick was submitted in May 2025 but never adopted, and no U.S. SWF existed as of mid-2026.

MANDATE

Treasury must administer the internal revenue laws — including paying the 48D, 45X and 48C credits as enacted in the CHIPS and Science Act (2022) and the Inflation Reduction Act (2022) as amended by the One Big Beautiful Bill Act (2025) — and the Secretary statutorily chairs CFIUS under Section 721 of the Defense Production Act (as amended by FIRRMA), with EO 14196 additionally tasking Treasury to develop (not create) a sovereign wealth fund plan.

CAN'T / CONSTRAINTS

Treasury cannot expand or extend the tax credits beyond statute: 48D dies for construction starting after 2026, 48C's $10B is exhausted, and 45X phases out on a fixed schedule with prohibited-foreign-entity exclusions; the credits go only to taxpayers meeting statutory eligibility, not discretionary picks. CFIUS jurisdiction covers only 'covered transactions' (foreign acquisitions/investments and certain real estate — generally not greenfield investment), and Treasury cannot capitalize a sovereign wealth fund without congressional authorization and appropriation, a key legal obstacle in the reported shelving of the plan.

WANTS

2025-2026 priorities: implement the America First Investment Policy — welcoming and fast-tracking allied capital while restricting adversary (especially PRC-linked) investment, and using CFIUS conditions aggressively (golden share model) to extract binding U.S. investment commitments; implement OBBBA's reshaped credits favoring semiconductors and non-wind/solar manufacturing with strict foreign-entity guardrails. The formal SWF ambition persists rhetorically but has been deprioritized in favor of transaction-by-transaction government equity stakes.

⚠ Section 48D effectively expires for facilities not under construction by December 31, 2026 — an imminent cliff; 45X wind-component credits end after 2027 with broader phase-down from 2030; 48C has no remaining capacity; the SWF initiative is stalled without congressional action; CFIUS authority is permanent. Leadership churn risk: the Assistant Secretary for Tax Policy announced departure in July 2026 amid broader IRS leadership turnover.

USIA angle — Tax credits are the cheapest, most rule-based dollars in every package — compute them first; they shrink what the sovereign pool must carry. CFIUS matters doubly for us: our own capital IS foreign sovereign money flowing into US strategic infrastructure, so alignment with the screening arm on structure and governance rights is existential, not optional. Watch Treasury as the natural turf claimant on anything labeled a sovereign fund.

NOT FULLY VERIFIED

SWF status ('shelved,' 'lower priority') rests on Bloomberg-sourced secondary reporting, not any official Treasury statement; no formal termination of EO 14196 was found.; Whether a successor to Kenneth Kies as Assistant Secretary for Tax Policy was in place by late July 2026 could not be verified.; The precise OBBBA treatment of forfeited 48C allocations (vanishing rather than re-pooled) is from practitioner summaries, not primary statutory text reviewed directly.; Dollar totals actually claimed to date under 48D and 45X were not verified (no consolidated official tally found).

U.S. Department of Agriculture, Rural Development (Rural Business-Cooperative Service business, energy and biorefinery finance programs)

Todd Lindsey — Acting Under Secretary of Agriculture for Rural Development **(acting)**

WHERE IT SITS

A mission area of USDA headed by a Senate-confirmed Under Secretary reporting to the Secretary of Agriculture (post vacant; nominee Glen Smith advanced out of Senate Agriculture Committee 12-11 on June 8, 2026 but awaits a floor vote), funded through annual Agriculture appropriations (credit-subsidy and grant accounts) plus Farm Bill mandatory funds.

WORKING LEVEL

J.R. Claeys, Administrator, Rural Business-Cooperative Service (in post since June 2, 2025); Victoria Collin, Deputy Administrator

FIREPOWER

- **Business & Industry (B&I) Guaranteed Loans (OneRD)** — Federal guarantees (now up to 90% for loans under $5M after March 2026 fee notice) on private-lender loans to rural businesses, generally up to $25M per borrower *(≈$3.5B obligated in FY2025 (record year, per industry analysis); subsidy rate 0.20% in FY2025; FY2026 Agriculture appropriations continued roughly $1.8-2B-scale program levels despite a Presidential budget proposal to terminate the program)*
- **Section 9003 Biorefinery, Renewable Chemical, and Biobased Product Manufacturing Assistance Program** — Loan guarantees up to $250M per project for first-of-a-kind advanced biofuel, renewable chemical, and biobased manufacturing facilities; program rule overhauled by final rule effective July 9, 2026 *(Up to $250M/project; remaining mandatory Farm Bill funding balance not publicly verified; pending bipartisan bill (Nunn-Budzinski, May 2025) would add $100M mandatory over 5 years)*
- **Rural Energy for America Program (REAP)** — Grants and loan guarantees for renewable-energy systems and energy-efficiency improvements for rural small businesses and ag producers *(Farm Bill mandatory baseline ~$50M/yr plus appropriations; status of remaining Inflation Reduction Act supplemental funds after 2025 rescission activity unverified)*
- **Rural Business Investment Program (RBIP)** — Licenses/certifies private Rural Business Investment Companies to raise and deploy private equity capital in rural businesses (no federal leverage since 2018 Farm Bill era) *(Private capital vehicles; USDA certified the Farmers Innovation Fund as a new fund in 2026)*
- **Rural Economic Development Loan & Grant (REDLG)** — Zero-interest loans and grants passed through rural electric/telephone utilities to local business projects *(FY2026 Notice of Funding Opportunity published September 15, 2025 (tens of millions annually))*

TRACK RECORD

The B&I guarantee program had a record year in FY2025 with roughly $3.5B in guaranteed loan volume at a 0.20% subsidy rate, and cumulative core obligations of about $13.4B over the prior decade. Recent 2025-2026 activity includes an $80M package of loan guarantees announced July 23, 2026 to expand timber production in Oregon and Nevada, roughly $294M in RD investments in West Virginia announced March 2026, 2026 certification of the Farmers Innovation Fund as a Rural Business Investment Company, and a July 2026 final rule streamlining the Section 9003 biorefinery loan guarantee program. The agency also cut OneRD guarantee fees and raised the guarantee to 90% for small B&I loans in its March 2026 fee notice.

MANDATE

Under the Consolidated Farm and Rural Development Act and Farm Bill Titles VI and IX, RD/RBCS must improve the economy and quality of life in rural America by providing loans, loan guarantees, and grants that create rural jobs and business opportunity, including a statutory mandate (Section 9003) to finance first-of-a-kind advanced biofuel, renewable chemical, and biobased manufacturing.

CAN'T / CONSTRAINTS

Business programs are restricted to rural areas (B&I generally limited to communities of 50,000 or fewer and adjacent urbanized areas) and mostly cannot lend directly (guarantees only, except pass-through vehicles like REDLG); Section 9003 guarantees are capped at $250M per project. Program authorities run on the 2018 Farm Bill as extended, which expires September 30, 2026, and guarantee volume depends on annually appropriated credit subsidy.

WANTS

2025-2026 priorities under the current administration: streamlining and speeding OneRD guaranteed lending (lower fees, higher guarantee percentages, modernized NEPA rules), supporting domestic energy/biofuels, timber, and manufacturing supply chains, and a USDA-wide reorganization moving staff closer to rural communities. The FY2026 President's Budget proposed terminating B&I (arguing private markets suffice) and floated moving business programs toward SBA — Congress instead continued funding.

⚠ 2018 Farm Bill extension (enacted November 12, 2025 in H.R. 5371) expires September 30, 2026, putting Section 9003 and other Title VI/IX authorities at a cliff; the FY2026 President's Budget proposed eliminating the B&I program (rejected by appropriators so far); the Under Secretary post is unfilled pending Glen Smith's full Senate vote; USDA's mass reorganization/relocation is ongoing.

USIA angle — Rural-sited plants and biomanufacturing. Their eligibility map should be an input at site selection, not an afterthought discovered at structuring.

NOT FULLY VERIFIED

Whether Glen Smith received a full Senate confirmation vote between June 8 and July 27, 2026 (no evidence found; treated as still pending); FY2025 B&I obligation figure (~$3.5B) comes from a private analytics firm (MMCG Invest), not verified against official USDA data; Exact FY2026 enacted program level for B&I (~$1.8B figure from a secondary summary); Remaining unobligated balance of Section 9003 mandatory funding; Status of IRA supplemental REAP funds after 2025 rescission legislation; Whether Victoria Collin is currently acting RBCS Administrator vs. Deputy (one July 2026 reference conflicted with Claeys as Administrator)

Build America Bureau (National Surface Transportation and Innovative Finance Bureau), U.S. Department of Transportation

Morteza Farajian — Executive Director, Build America Bureau

WHERE IT SITS

Sits inside the Office of the Secretary of Transportation (under the Under Secretary for Policy); its Executive Director is a non-Senate-confirmed official (Farajian has led it since April 2019 across three administrations) answering to the Secretary, with lending capacity funded by IIJA/appropriated credit subsidy and statutory loan authorizations rather than grant appropriations.

FIREPOWER

- **TIFIA direct loans/credit assistance** — Low-interest (Treasury-rate) loans and credit support for up to 33% (49% for transit and TOD) of eligible surface-transportation project costs *(IIJA provided ~$1.25B in credit subsidy FY2022-26 (~$250M/yr), each subsidy dollar supporting roughly $10-14 in loans; Bureau credit portfolio ~$29B (2024-25); House BUILD America 250 Act would provide $1.25B over FY2027-31)*
- **RRIF direct loans** — Loans for up to 100% of eligible railroad rehabilitation/improvement and transit-oriented development costs *($35B statutory lending authorization, the large majority historically unused (roughly $25-28B headroom per CRS); Brightline West has a $21.05B RRIF request in the Bureau's June 1, 2026 pipeline)*
- **Transportation Private Activity Bonds (PABs)** — Allocations of tax-exempt bond authority to private developers in surface-transportation P3s *($30B national cap (doubled from $15B by IIJA in 2021) essentially exhausted — about $29B allocated as of October 2025; DOT is asking Congress to raise the cap)*
- **Project development / technical assistance (incl. Regional Infrastructure Accelerators, Asset Concessions program)** — Pre-development grants and advisory support to build a P3 and TOD deal pipeline *(P3/credit pipeline pending before the Bureau of roughly $50B (2025-26))*

TRACK RECORD

Since its 2016 creation the Bureau has built a credit portfolio of roughly $29B in TIFIA/RRIF loans plus over $22B (now ~$29B allocated) in PABs supporting megaprojects such as Brightline Florida and numerous managed-lanes and transit P3s. Recent activity includes a $291.2M RRIF loan to MBTA for the Widett Circle project (announced January 2025), the first-ever transit-oriented-development TIFIA loan, and $327M in TIFIA and RRIF loans to Sound Transit for three projects (2026). Underwriting has historically taken a year or more, and in 2025 Secretary Duffy announced policy changes to remove financing roadblocks and speed closings; the June 1, 2026 pipeline report shows tens of billions in pending letters of interest including Brightline West's $21.05B RRIF request.

MANDATE

Created by the FAST Act of 2015 as the National Surface Transportation and Innovative Finance Bureau, it must administer DOT's credit programs (TIFIA, 23 U.S.C. 601-609; RRIF, 45 U.S.C. 821-823), allocate transportation PABs (26 U.S.C. 142(m)), and provide technical assistance to accelerate delivery of transportation infrastructure and attract private co-investment.

CAN'T / CONSTRAINTS

It is a financing shop, not a grantmaker: TIFIA is capped at 33% (49% for some categories) of eligible costs, requires investment-grade creditworthiness and dedicated repayment streams, and all credit is contingent on available subsidy authority; RRIF is limited to rail/TOD purposes; PAB allocations are hard-capped at $30B and are now nearly gone. Borrowers must satisfy federal cross-cutting requirements (NEPA, Buy America, Davis-Bacon), and current TIFIA contract authority runs on the IIJA, which expires September 30, 2026.

WANTS

2025-2026 leadership priorities: dramatically expand P3s and private capital in infrastructure, get Congress to lift the PAB cap and expand TIFIA/RRIF in the next surface bill, push TIFIA into transit-oriented development, housing-adjacent, and airport projects, and cut approval timelines (Duffy's 2025 removal of financing policy roadblocks; NEPA streamlining for TOD in the pending House bill).

⚠ IIJA surface-transportation authorization (including TIFIA contract authority) expires September 30, 2026; the House T&I Committee approved the successor BUILD America 250 Act ($580B, 5 years, incl. $1.25B TIFIA and modest TIFIA/RRIF expansions) 62-2 on May 22, 2026, but the Senate has not moved a companion; the $30B PAB cap is effectively exhausted pending congressional action.

USIA angle — TIFIA/RRIF finance the roads and rail around a megasite — never the plant itself. Bring them in during site diligence for the enabling- infrastructure layer of the package.

NOT FULLY VERIFIED

Farajian's incumbency as of July 2026 is supported by DOT's leadership directory and continuing references but not by a dated July-2026 primary document; Exact remaining RRIF headroom (~$25-28B) and remaining IIJA TIFIA subsidy balance not re-verified for 2026; Precise closing date of the $327M Sound Transit TIFIA/RRIF loans (2026, month unverified); Identity of the current Director of the Bureau's Office of Credit Programs (working-level lead) could not be verified for 2026; Portfolio figures ($29B credit / $22-29B PABs) mix 2024 testimony and 2025 reporting; Verifier (reauth): corrected — The House T&I Committee vote on the BUILD America 250 Act (H.R. 8870) on May 22, 2026 was 61-2 per NACo's markup report, not 62-2. The rest checks out: IIJA surface transportation authorization expires September 30, 2026; the bill authorizes ~$580B over 5 years (FY2027-31) including $1.25B for TIFIA; no evidence of a Senate companion moving was found. The claim that the $30B PAB cap is effectively exhausted could not be independently re-verified (Bureau pages unreachable), though bios already showed $22B+ allocated/issued/pending.

Biomedical Advanced Research and Development Authority (BARDA), Administration for Strategic Preparedness and Response (ASPR), U.S. Department of Health and Human Services — including ASPR industrial-base expansion (IBx/IBMSC) investments

Gary L. Disbrow — Deputy Assistant Secretary and Director, BARDA

WHERE IT SITS

BARDA sits inside ASPR at HHS; its career Director reports to the Senate-confirmed Assistant Secretary for Preparedness and Response — a post vacant since January 20, 2025 (nominee Sean Kaufman's HELP Committee vote was postponed July 23, 2026) — and the agency is funded through annual Labor-HHS appropriations (BARDA ARD line, Project BioShield Special Reserve Fund, pandemic influenza line) plus emergency supplementals, amid a contested March 2025 HHS reorganization that would move ASPR into CDC.

FIREPOWER

- **BARDA advanced R&D contracts (ARD line)** — Cost-shared advanced development contracts and other transactions carrying medical countermeasures from candidate through FDA approval *(Roughly $1B/yr discretionary (FY2025 enacted ~$1.0B; FY2026 request was $654M but Senate appropriators flat-funded or increased; FY2027 request cuts the line by $395.6M))*
- **Project BioShield Special Reserve Fund** — Multi-year procurement of medical countermeasures against DHS-designated material threats, creating a guaranteed government market *(≈$850M enacted FY2026; FY2027 request $725M (a $125M cut))*
- **BioMaP-C (Biopharmaceutical Manufacturing Preparedness Consortium) / ASPR IBx-IBMSC onshoring awards** — Other-transaction consortium awards to build and sustain domestic commercial-scale manufacturing of essential medicines, APIs, antimicrobials, and large-volume parenterals *(Hundreds of millions in awards to date; new RPP issued 2026 for drug substance/drug product capacity (no published ceiling verified))*
- **BARDA Ventures (with Global Health Investment Corp)** — Venture-capital-style equity investments in health-security technologies *(Planned up to ~$500M over 10 years from 2021 launch (current pace unverified))*

TRACK RECORD

Since 2006 BARDA has shepherded scores of FDA-approved/licensed countermeasures and executed the largest US biomedical surge in history during COVID-19 (Operation Warp Speed vaccines and therapeutics). In 2025-2026 the portfolio pivoted sharply: HHS cancelled roughly $500M of BARDA mRNA vaccine projects (22 awards) in August 2025 and terminated Moderna's $590M pre-pandemic flu award in June 2026, while expanding domestic-manufacturing investment through BioMaP-C awards for essential medicines and committing $50M in June 2026 for Bundibugyo Ebola countermeasures amid the DRC outbreak. ASPR's IBx/IBMSC has concurrently funded onshoring of API and sterile-injectable capacity to reduce foreign dependence.

MANDATE

Under PHS Act Section 319L (created by the Pandemic and All-Hazards Preparedness Act of 2006) BARDA must support advanced research, development, and procurement of medical countermeasures against CBRN threats, pandemic influenza, and emerging infectious diseases, bridging the 'valley of death' between NIH research and FDA approval; the Project BioShield Act of 2004 directs SRF procurement against material threats, and ASPR is separately charged with strengthening the medical industrial base and supply chains.

CAN'T / CONSTRAINTS

BARDA cannot fund basic research (advanced development only), and BioShield SRF purchases are limited to countermeasures against formally designated material threats; it is a funder, not a regulator, and depends on FDA action for approvals. Core PAHPA authorities lapsed September 30, 2023 and remain unreauthorized as of mid-2026, leaving programs running on appropriations, and statute requires the ASPR to report directly to the HHS Secretary — one legal obstacle to the proposed transfer into CDC.

WANTS

FY2027 request and 2025-2026 leadership statements prioritize onshoring and expanding domestic MCM and essential-medicine manufacturing (IBx, BioMaP-C), late-stage development and stockpiling against DHS material threats, and — per HHS political leadership — a deliberate wind-down of mRNA platform investment in favor of other vaccine platforms.

⚠ PAHPA reauthorization has been pending since authorities lapsed September 30, 2023 (still being urged on Congress as of June 2026); the March 2025 HHS reorganization moving ASPR into CDC is partially enjoined (July 2025 Rhode Island preliminary injunction) though the Supreme Court stayed a related workforce injunction; the ASPR post is vacant with Kaufman's committee vote postponed July 23, 2026; the FY2027 budget requests a $395.6M cut to BARDA and $125M cut to BioShield.

USIA angle — Pharma-onshoring co-investor: grants plus procurement demand. Health-security framing is the key that unlocks their money for our API/biomanufacturing deals.

NOT FULLY VERIFIED

Disbrow's incumbency as of July 2026 rests on official ASPR/medicalcountermeasures.gov pages that may be stale; no dated mid-2026 news item independently re-confirmed him; Name of the official currently performing the duties of Assistant Secretary (acting ASPR) could not be identified; FY2026 enacted amounts for the BARDA ARD line and BioShield (~$850M) are partly derived from stated FY2027-request deltas, not seen directly in an enacted-appropriations table; BARDA Ventures capacity (~$500M/10 years) is from 2021-era announcements; current pace unverified; Dollar totals for ASPR IBMSC/IBx onshoring awards and BioMaP-C ceilings not publicly verified; Post-injunction operational status of the ASPR-to-CDC transfer as of July 2026 is unclear (litigation ongoing); Verifier (capacity): cannot-verify

U.S. Investment Accelerator (USIA), Department of Commerce

AMS — Executive Director

WHERE IT SITS

Established by EO 14255 (March 31, 2025) within Commerce; the ED reports directly to the Secretary; administers the CHIPS Program Office; Commerce CFO supports fund operations.

WORKING LEVEL

Josh Kroon, acting Deputy Director (DAS, ITA)

FIREPOWER

- **Allied sovereign-capital pool** — Investment commitments under the Japan, Korea, and Taiwan agreements, drawn by capital call and invested domestically in strategic infrastructure *(~$900B committed (internal figure))*
- **CHIPS grants / loans / equity** — Administered in-house via the CHIPS Program Office *($39B grants (mostly awarded); $75B loan authority; equity conversions)*
- **Convening & priority** — One federal face; the Secretary's and White House's priority; fast-track for $1B+ investments

TRACK RECORD

Converted Intel's remaining CHIPS grants into an $8.9B ~10% equity stake (Aug 2025); houses U.S. rare-earth stakes and the US Steel golden-share arrangement; fast-tracks $1B+ investments under EO 14255. First ED departed Jan 2026; office rebuilding under new leadership.

MANDATE

Deploy allied sovereign capital into U.S. strategic infrastructure — select projects, make capital calls on partner governments, invest domestically — and serve as front door and federal-package assembler for $1B+ investments; administer CHIPS.

CAN'T / CONSTRAINTS

EO-based, not statutory — no organic authorization or appropriation of its own beyond CHIPS; staff depth far behind its balance sheet; capital-call governance still being built.

WANTS

Deploy the pool with speed and discipline; staff up (investment, legal, research); set durable precedents for equity terms.

⚠ Rests on an executive order, not statute; continuity depends on administration priority.

USIA angle — What we bring: the ~$900B allied sovereign pool (Japan, Korea, Taiwan commitments drawn by capital call, invested domestically in strategic infrastructure), CHIPS money in-house, White House priority, the Secretary's convening power, and one federal face for every counterparty. We are usually the biggest equity check at the table. What we still need from this page: debt to stretch the pool, demand-side certainty to de-risk it, tax/permitting to speed it, specialist diligence to protect it — and people.

NOT FULLY VERIFIED

The ~$900B pool figure and capital-call mechanics reflect internal understanding, not publicly verified sources.